



M18.1 Solution Guide - Monitoring Assets

In this activity, you evaluated a series of security events and ranked them based on OPM's specific business priorities.

Note: There is no definitively correct order. The important thing is that you provide an explanation for why you choose your order.

The following is an example solution:

- A. (1) An employee in the Omaha office recently downloaded ransomware from a phishing email onto their work laptop.
- B. (3) The primary web server in the New York office briefly experienced an outage due to a DDoS attack.
- C. (8) The administrative application website occasionally experiences brute force attacks.
- D. (5) Vendors were inadvertently provided physical access to the data center in the Atlanta office.
- E. (6) A terminated employee was not removed from the active directory and has continued to log into their account.
- F. (4) SQL injection attacks were attempted on the primary purchasing web application.
- G. (2) Last month, an inventory database audit log ran out of disk space and stopped writing.
- H. (7) In the last several weeks, the VPN logs showed a source IP coming from Asia, where no employees are located.

Explanations

- (1) An employee in the Omaha office recently downloaded ransomware from a phishing email onto their work laptop.
 - This is the top priority because if the ransomware spreads onto OPM's network, it could encrypt OPM's data and have a major impact on business operations.
- (2–7): These events were ranked in order based on the potential impact they could cause to OPM financially and reputationally.
- (8): The administrative application website occasionally experiences brute force attacks.

- This is the lowest priority because public-facing web applications often experience brute force attacks. As long as there is a rule in place such as "three failed logins then lockout," the application is protected.